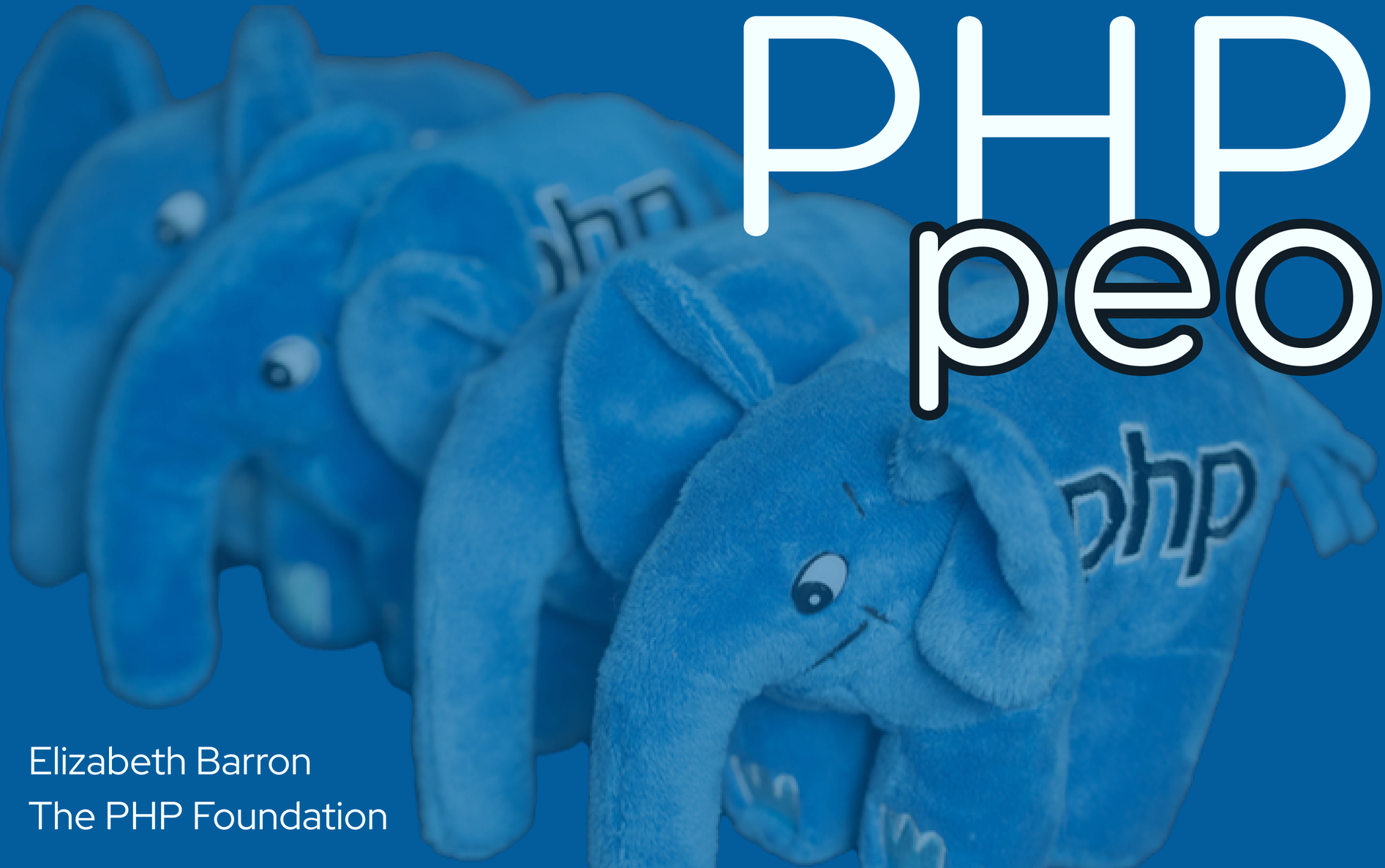
Longhorn PHP 2026

PHP IS people



Elizabeth Barron
The PHP Foundation

thephp.foundation

Longhorn PHP 2026

THE PHP FOUNDATION

https://thephp.foundation



OUR MISSION

To ensure the long-term prosperity of the PHP language.



WHO WE ARE

We have 14 contracted developers, most are part-time.
We are financially supported by donations and grants.
We are governed by a Board of Directors.
We are managed by an Executive Director (that's me!)
We partner with an Advisory Board for high level insight.



THANK YOU to our Platinum Sponsors:

JetBrains
AUTOMATTIC
Sovereign Tech Agency
Alpha-Omega

WHO WE AREN'T

We don't own or direct the PHP language.
We don't make decisions about the PHP language.
We aren't a for-profit organization.



WHAT WE WORK ON

Maintenance

- Triaging and handling issues
- Writing and reviewing PRs

Security

- Triaging and handling reports
- Writing and issuing security patches

RFCs and Features

- Writing and commenting on RFCs
- Writing new features

https://thephp.foundation/blog/2026/05/27/impact-and-transparency-report-2025/
https://thephp.foundation/blog/2026/07/21/quarterly-report-q2-2026/

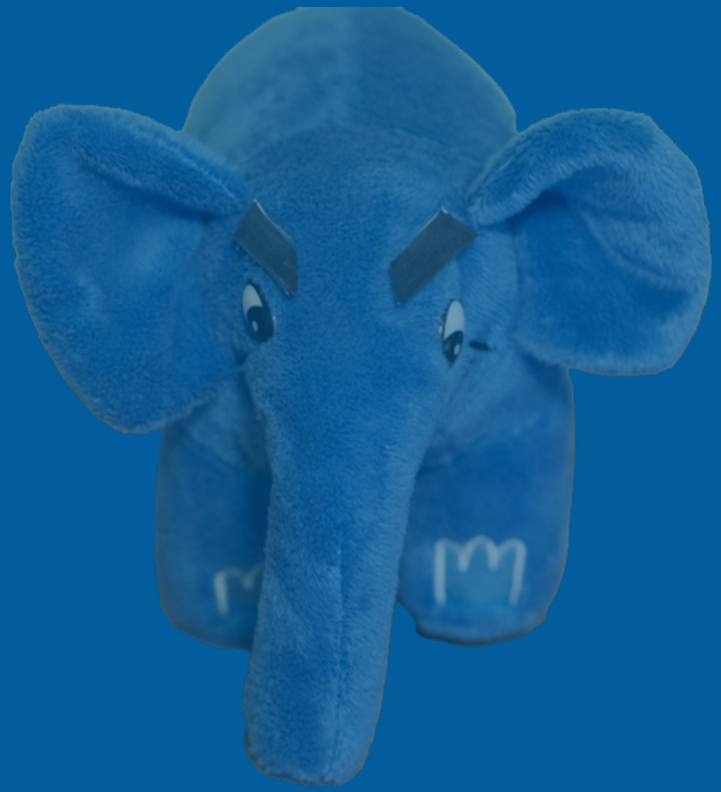
MAINTENANCE

About 80-100 new issues are opened on php-src every month. All require humans.

2025-June 2026: About 190 PRs submitted every month.
July 2026-Now: They jumped to 366–451 a month, *roughly double the year before*.



SECURITY



Foundation contractors work with community members to read, validate, and triage every security report that comes in. Those that need fixes are written/reviewed by humans.

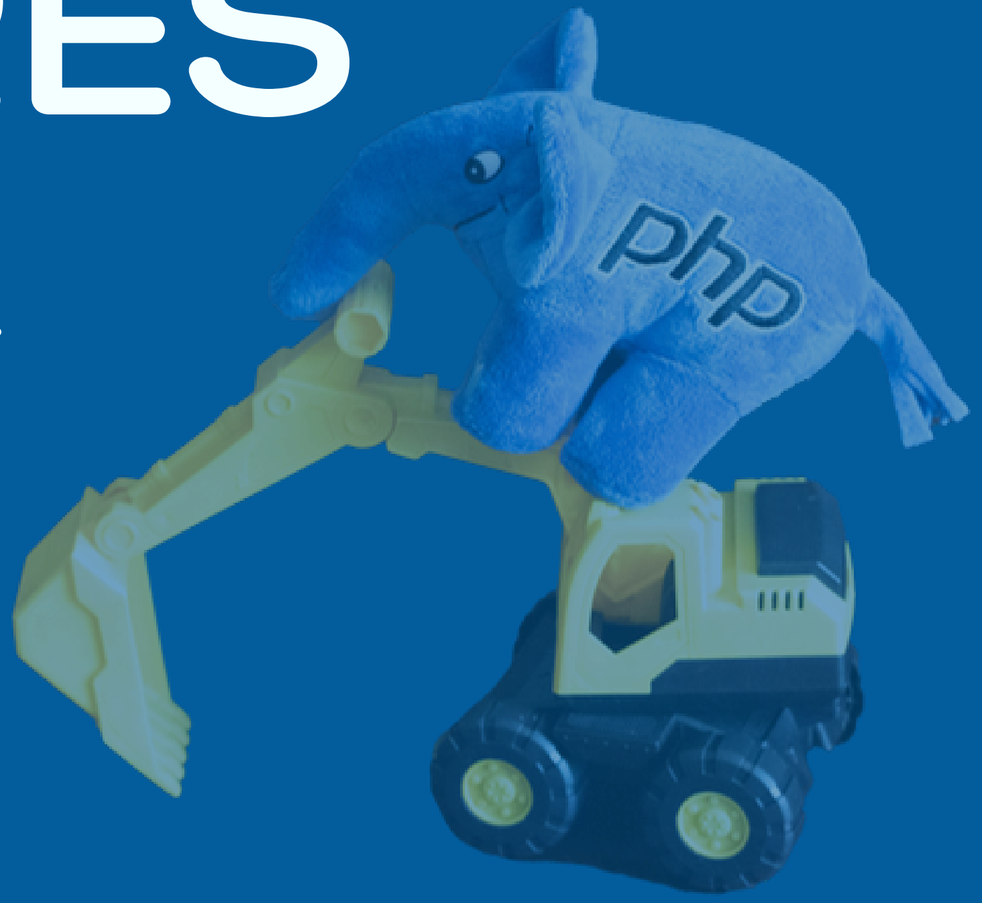
With every new model, comes another wave of reports.

https://thephp.foundation/blog/2026/10/14/how-the-php-security-team-handles-your-reports/

RFC & NEW FEATURES

Authored/Co-authored 20 RFCs in 2025.

13 were accepted and implemented (or are in the process of being implemented.)



WHAT ELSE, THOUGH?

Listening Tour in March-April 2026
provided feedback in 4 areas:



- The PHP Foundation
- PHP marketing and outreach
- New user pipeline
- PHP the language

https://thephp.foundation/blog/2026/04/16/integrating-community-feedback-into-foundation-strategy-part1/
https://thephp.foundation/blog/2026/06/11/integrating-community-feedback-into-foundation-strategy-part2/

SPECIAL INTEREST GROUPS

PHP Ambassador Program

- Research
- Marketing
- Speakers

Onboarding Initiative

- Basic Content
- Differentiation

Community Events Coalition

- TBD!
- First meeting is October 28 at 13:00 UTC

Accessibility and Inclusion Group is Coming Soon

To join a SIG: https://forms.gle/xan327uhfQDdCzfs6

CHALLENGES REMAIN

Core Contributors

- Pool of potential contributors is shrinking
- Still have Contributor Absence Factor problem

AI Uncertainty

- Ambiguity around impact, copyright, policy, legal responsibility
- Building trust in AI land, reducing maintainer load

Reduced Funding

- Free rider problem
- Meaning of “Free” in FOSS
- No easy systems
- Short supply chain consideration

SO WHAT DO WE DO?




WE DEFINITELY
CAN'T DO IT
ALONE
The PHP
Foundation

THINGS YOU

- Come to events and bring friends!
- Share your knowledge with someone through a blog post or video
- Join the PHPC Discord
- Join a Foundation Special Interest Group
- Support the Foundation or other projects financially
- Advocate for PHP internally at your company
- Contribute to Documentation (including on places like GitHub where PHP docs are sparse)

- Test pre-releases of PHP core
- Reproduce someone else's bug
- Write tests for PHP core or a project you depend on
- Read internals mailing list and be informed
- Organize a local user group/meetup
- Advocate for sponsorship or financial support in your company for projects you depend on
- Tell your PHP success stories
- Promote PHP outside our spaces
- Listen to and support community podcasts
- Answer questions from new learners

CAN DO

PHP HAS GIVEN US OUR LIVELIHOODS FOR 31 YEARS



NOW IT'S TIME TO GIVE BACK TO PHP



Longhorn PHP 2026

THANK YOU



Link to these slides

Link to donate

Please consider donating to The PHP Foundation to enable us to keep doing this work: https://opencollective.com/phpfoundation